
MEETING MINUTES

The Eighteenth Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

November 18, 2024

Executive Session 5:15 p.m.

Regular Meeting: 6:00 pm

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - 7/0
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Executive Session

Upon a Motion to enter into executive session pursuant to M. G.L. c. 30A §21(a) .

Executive session pursuant to G.L c. 30A (a) (3): the Medford School Committee will convene in Executive Session to update on negotiations with **Medford Educational Secretaries (AFSCME Council 93) and the Massachusetts Nurses Association** because an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining position of the Committee and the Chair so declares.

Executive session pursuant to Chapter 30A section 21 (2) to conduct strategy in preparation with nonunion personnel or contract negotiations with nonunion personnel (superintendent of schools).

The Medford School Committee will convene in public session immediately following the conclusion of the executive session, approximately at 6:00pm.

Motion to Enter into Executive Session by Member Intoppa, second by Member Branley - 7/0

- IV. Consent Agenda
 - Approval of Bills and Payrolls
 - Approval of Capital Purchases
 - Approval of Grants
 - Approval of Field Trips
 - Model UN Field Trip to Georgetown University - Washington D.C.
 - NOTIFICATION - Model UN Field Trip to Dartmouth University, Hanover, NH
 - Notifying the Committee so we can publicize. Will formally request approval in coming weeks.
 - Approval of Meeting Minutes
 - Regular Meeting, November 4, 2024

Motion to approve Consent Agenda by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Branley - 7/0

Student Representative present - Jayden Vil

V. Report of Subcommittees

VI. Report of the Superintendent

1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
2. **After School Report** - Megan Fidler-Carey, Director of Family & Community Engagement
 - Committee was disappointed to hear that City Year is not solving the staffing issues for after school at the end of the day, which is what was thought of in starting the partnership. Not necessarily them being at fault, but something to look into and other ways to improve.
 - Committee suggested working with Ms. Bowen to help staff children with special assistance needs to help alleviate the before school waitlist.
 - National bus driver shortage continues to impact all programs.
 - What happens if you don't have the required ratios for some reason?
 - After School is a licensed exempt because we are in a school building. When we are short staffed the program is less individualized and more group activity driven.
 - Add to the final report to show the improvements to the program and work with the Communications Director to update the website and combine all the independent charts to improve the quick look in one place.
 - Include after school job openings to the weekly memo.
3. **CTE Enrollment Report** - Mr. Chad Fallon, Director/Principal of Medford Vocational Technical High School
 - When vocational enrollment used to be low; grades, discipline and attendance were the admissions criteria.
 - Would like to see it be more of a lottery.
 - Committee suggested better communication/education to ninth grade parents that this is a choice for the next three years.
 - We will find ways to communicate and promote better.
 - Most vocational schools have an application process and we are "come one, come all" which is a good problem to have, but we do have to turn students away because there is not enough room.
 - The Advisory Board meeting had about 120 attendees. The love in that room for our vocational program was impressive.
 - **Awards given to an employee partner who hires our students.**
 - **This year the award was given to Asher Nicols.**
 - Still a myth out there that if you go to vocational school you can't go to college.

4. **Draft FY26 Budget Calendar** – Mr. Gerald McCue, Budget Analyst

- Mr. McCue asked for a bit more time at the beginning of the process. January and February to be budget development and the month of March for development and budget hearings.
- We will continue to adhere to the previous draft.
- This was the first year with the policy being in place.
- This is supposed to align with the Capital Improvement Plan and City timeline.
- Review again in the Fall and if this works it should be permanent.
- Date changes to come by Mr. McCue to the Committee.

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm) – None

VII. Continued Business – None

VIII. New Business

2024-41 Offered by Mayor Lungo-Koehn

The Medford Public Schools in accordance with M.G.L. 149(a), Section 4(a)(1) authorizes using construction management at risk services for the McGlynn School Complex and the Andrews Middle School HVAC upgrade project and authorizes the Mayor to sign the risk services contract with a construction management at risk firm to perform all of its obligations in connection with the project.

Date Submitted: November 8, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: November 18, 2024

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Ruseau – 7/0

2024-42 Offered by Member Reinfeld

WHEREAS a resolution was offered and approved at the June 24, 2024 special meeting of the Medford School Committee that the committee receive a report by December 15 describing the implementation and impact of position reductions between the previous and current budget year to inform the budget request for the upcoming fiscal year; and

WHEREAS the voters of Medford authorized on November 5, 2024 the assessment of additional tax funds to support the district's staffing needs and expanded access to programming;
Be it therefore resolved that the report shall focus on concerns identified during the spring budget hearings and priorities expressed during the fall campaign season including but not limited to the district's ability to provide students with ongoing and acute mental health support, arts and vocational programming, and administrative support, as well as the effect of staffing changes on

class and caseload sizes.

Be it further resolved that presentation of the report be limited to roles and responsibilities, independent of individual employees' performances and other confidential matters.

Date Submitted: November 13, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: November 18, 2024

2024-43 Offered by Mayor Lungo-Koehn and Member Graham

Be it resolved that the administration will present a proposed supplemental budget to account for funds made available through the passage of ballot questions 7 & 8 at our January 13th meeting.

Date Submitted: November 14, 2024.

Date Requested to be on Agenda: November 18, 2024

Motion to consolidate 2024-42 and 2024-43 by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham - 7/0

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0

2024-44 Offered by Member Graham

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee formally appoints Will Pipicelli as a non-voting member of the Medford Comprehensive High School Building Committee and removes Thomas Dalton as a non-voting member.

Date Submitted: November 14, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: November 18, 2024

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0

IX. Reports Requested - None

X. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Maureen L. Kidney**, mother of Kim Flaherty who works at Medford High School in support of Transportation and is a member of our administrative assistant unit.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Laurel Shuman**, mother of Johanna Granada, Speech Therapist at the Roberts Elementary School.

XI. Next Regular Meeting

December 2, 2024 - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XII. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Branley - 7/0
Meeting adjourned at 8:11 pm